Medicare Grievance Detection: Gap Analysis

Medicare calls, Aug 7 – Sep 10 · AI grievance flags compared with CSR flags and adjudicator decisions · first-pass review, to be confirmed by the grievance team

987	633	311	385	255
AI grievance detections	Kept by the adjudicator	Also flagged by the CSR	Gap: kept, but not CSR-flagged	Rejected by the adjudicator

Of 987 AI detections, the adjudicator kept 633, rejected 255 and marked 83 uncertain (16 had no decision). The 385 gap detections cover 365 unique calls.

Finding 1: What CSRs are mostly missing: everyday complaints

CSRs do **not** wait for words like “complaint” or “supervisor”: those appeared in only **3%** of CSR-flagged detections and **1%** of gap detections. What CSRs miss are complaints said in **everyday language while the caller is asking for help**. Real caller wording from gap calls (de-identified, checked against the transcript and attributed to the caller):

What the caller said	The problem behind it
“I was getting very frustrated today.”	Repeated trouble registering for the member portal and completing verification
“If you don’t explain it, you’re making it sound like they cover everything, but they don’t.”	Felt coverage had been described as broader than it was; unhappy with the limited benefits
“I don’t know what happened to your phone system, but it’s really making it impossible.”	Could not get through the phone system to reach help
“I get the runaround every time I call. I got different answers.”	Repeated calls with conflicting answers

None of these callers asked to “file a complaint”, but each clearly described a problem.

The CSR hears a problem and works to fix it, so the call is not logged as a grievance. Compared with the calls CSRs did log, gap calls contain more **misinformation** (8% vs 5%), **unclear explanations** (8% vs 6%) and **no explicit complaint phrase** (8% vs 6%), and fewer complaints about a **dentist’s care** (6% vs 14%), which CSRs log more readily. 356 of 385 gap detections had a caller phrase showing a problem; 29 had none. A first read judged **353 of 385 gap detections (92%)** likely grievances and 31 borderline; **the grievance team needs to confirm.**

Finding 2: Why the AI flags more calls: it treats any dissatisfaction as a grievance

The AI flagged a call whenever the caller was unhappy about almost anything, including the plan, a dentist, a dental office or the phone system. Themes from the review of the 385 gap calls (paraphrased, de-identified):

What the caller was unhappy about	Examples from the gap calls
Plan coverage or value	Dentures or implants excluded despite an extra premium; a lower annual maximum than expected; told the new plan was better, then faced higher costs
Finding a dentist / network	Listed dentists did not accept the plan; nearest in-network oral surgeon about 70 miles away; long-time dentist left the network without notice
Phone system and transfers	Automated system did not understand the caller or the member ID; transferred between several departments; disconnected during a transfer
Dentist’s care or conduct	Bridge or dentures that did not fit or caused pain; a crown that led to infection; office staff described as rude
Dental-office billing	Quoted one price and charged more; billed for work the caller says was not done; slow refunds
Missing payments or claims	Reimbursement check never arrived after several calls; dentist said a claim was sent but the plan had none on file
Broken promises / wrong info	Promised dentist list, email or callback never came; told a dentist was in network, later learned it was not

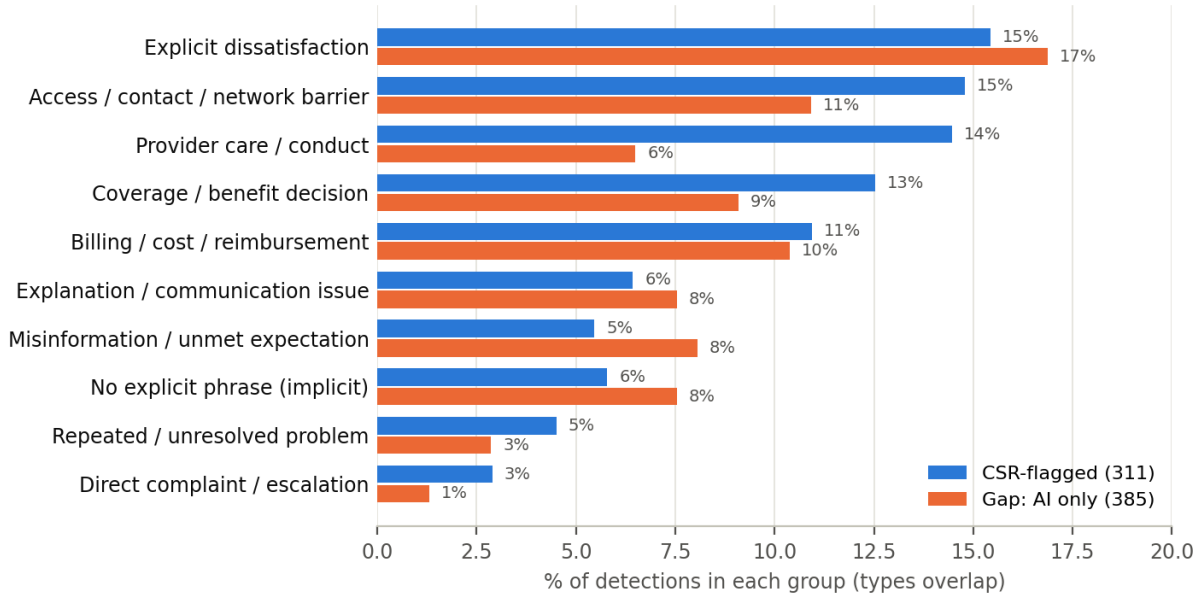
Where the AI flag looks weak (likely over-flagging)

- **Information requests:** e.g. a caller asking whether the premium had changed, or asking about a charge and then saying it was not a complaint.
- **Unclear speaker:** a few complaint-like lines could not be clearly attributed to the caller rather than the representative.
- **Same call counted more than once:** 385 detections came from 365 calls, which inflates the AI total.
- **Rejected or uncertain flags:** the adjudicator rejected 255 AI flags and was unsure on 83. Their reasons have not been analysed yet and are the main source for tightening the prompt.

Note: complaints about a dentist or dental office are within the grievance scope used here, so a dentist being involved does not by itself make an AI flag wrong.

Open question for the grievance team: when a caller describes a problem in everyday words while asking for help (and never says “complaint”), should it be logged as a grievance? If yes, CSR logging needs to expand; if no, the AI prompt should be tightened.

Supporting detail: what callers expressed in each group



One detection can show several types, so bars do not add to 100%. A residual “other explicit wording” type (30% CSR, 35% gap) is not shown.

Next steps

Step	Purpose
1. Grievance-team review of a gap sample (about 50: 25 likely, 25 borderline)	Confirm which everyday complaints should be grievances, and answer the open question above.
2. Count calls per theme; analyse the 255 rejected and 83 uncertain detections	Size each theme and find where AI flags do not hold up, to turn them into prompt rules.
3. Update the prompt and/or CSR guidance, then re-test on this month’s calls	Measure how the gap changes without losing real grievances.

How this was done

Transcripts were de-identified before analysis. Each call was read in full by an AI coding agent; only the caller’s words counted as complaint phrases. The file contains AI-flagged calls only, so it cannot show grievances CSRs logged on calls the AI missed, or overall CSR grievance rates. All judgments are preliminary until the grievance team confirms them.